

# Franco Lopez

Platform & DevOps Engineer

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Platform and DevOps engineer with over 15 years of experience in software engineering, cloud infrastructure, and production systems. I design and operate Kubernetes platforms, modernize cloud and identity infrastructure, and build automation and internal platforms used by hundreds of users across North America. Bilingual in English and Spanish.

## CORE STACK

### Platform Engineering

Linux · Kubernetes · Docker · Talos Linux · VMware · Hyper-V · Networking · Fortinet · Cisco

### Cloud & Identity

Microsoft Azure · GCP · Linode · Cloudflare · Azure IaaS · Azure AD / Entra ID · MFA · Conditional Access

### DevOps & Automation

GitOps · Flux CD · GitHub Actions · CI/CD · Helm · Bash · Python · Automation

### Development

PostgreSQL · REST APIs · SQL · React · Claris Filemaker · PHP · Microsoft 365

## EXPERIENCE

### LS Tractor USA — IT Manager — Platform Engineering · *Raleigh, NC*

Oct 2022 – Present

- Lead platform engineering initiatives supporting manufacturing systems, dealer platforms, cloud infrastructure, networking, identity, and cybersecurity across North American operations.
- Design and operate production Kubernetes platforms supporting internal and dealer-facing applications, including CI/CD workflows, containerized deployments, backup strategies, and disaster recovery.
- Modernized enterprise identity by migrating 200+ users from on-prem Active Directory to Microsoft Entra ID with Azure AD Connect, MFA, Conditional Access, and OneDrive adoption.
- Designed and deployed complete infrastructure for new manufacturing facilities in Texas and North Carolina, including networking, compute, security, identity, and secure remote access.
- Build internal platforms and automation that streamline dealer operations, employee training, and corporate workflows.

### Interamerican Foods Corp. / La Moderna USA — IT Manager — Cloud Infrastructure · *Cleburne, TX*

Jun 2017 – Oct 2022

- Stood up the entire IT and infrastructure stack for a 24/7 automated manufacturing facility from greenfield — networking, compute, storage, identity, and OT/IT integration.
- Designed and deployed the company's US web platform (lamodernausa.com) on Azure IaaS, including DNS, TLS, and supporting infrastructure.
- Built and implemented a multi-tier cloud backup and disaster recovery system to protect multiple 24/7 production and packaging line servers, with automated validation and failover testing, reducing recovery time from over 1 hour to under 10 minutes.
- Hardened the perimeter with next-gen firewalls, Cloudflare DNS/WAF, WireGuard VPN, and network segmentation across distributed sites.
- Led Cisco Meraki rollout (networking, wireless, security cameras) across all US locations with zero production downtime.

### SR Traffic Service Inc. — Software Engineer · *Laredo, TX*

Jan 2010 – Jun 2017

- Built a Warehouse Management System from scratch — barcode generation, handheld scanner integration, mobile and desktop clients, real-time inventory, customs documentation, and client-facing reporting. Served 20+ international clients across 4 facilities.
- Designed REST APIs and SQL-backed workflows powering inventory, dispatch, customs paperwork, and customer portals.
- Automated build, test, and deployment processes; migrated workloads to cloud infrastructure for scalability and cost control.

## PROJECTS

### Start Blue — Production Quote Platform [startblue.lstractorusa.com](https://startblue.lstractorusa.com)

Design and operate a production 3-node Kubernetes platform serving more than 350 dealers across the US and Canada. Built the React + PostgreSQL application, deployment pipelines, backup strategy, and disaster recovery. Two years in production with no major incidents and more than 2,000 quotes processed.

### Azure AD / Entra ID Migration

Modernized enterprise identity by migrating more than 200 users from on-prem Active Directory to Microsoft Entra ID with Azure AD Connect, MFA, Conditional Access, GPO modernization, and NAS-to-OneDrive migration.

### Cybersecurity & Disaster Recovery

Designed and implemented a multi-layer backup and disaster recovery strategy, secured public-facing services with Cloudflare, deployed WireGuard VPN for secure remote access, and strengthened infrastructure security through network hardening and recovery validation.

## EDUCATION & CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified Kubernetes Administrator (CKA) — The Linux Foundation (In progress)
- B.S. Computer Systems Engineering — Universidad del Valle de México (2005 – 2010)
- Microsoft Azure Fundamentals (AZ-900) — Microsoft (Mar 2022)
- Engineering Cisco Meraki Solutions — Cisco Meraki (Sep 2021)
- HPE SimpliVity 380 System Administration (VMware) — HPE (Apr 2019)